AskAI setup & health

[ ] optional < > required a | b pick one Full detail: askai help <command>

START HERE · the one-time sequence

ONCE PER MACHINE

1 `curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/aalokshah-business/AskAi/main/get.sh | bash -s -- --yes`

Install AskAI (macOS, Linux, WSL, devcontainer). Windows: get.ps1 -Yes. Container: askai bootstrap --repo writes the post-create script.

2 `askai install --retry`

Finish anything that needed a new shell, a package or a sign-in. Finished parts are skipped.

3 `askai check --all | askai infra | askai status`

Verify: 0 failing, every host, MCP server, plugin and tier listed.

ONCE PER PROJECT

4 `askai init`

In the project folder. Scans the code, writes the pack, agents and Cursor commands. No model, no tokens.

5 `Reload the Cursor window, or start a new Claude Code session`

They read the new files only after that.

6 `/askai-cli --review  Codex: $askai-cli --review`

Start here. Opens the AskAI terminal for the project and has the agent review the generated project files and fill the gaps. This is the one step that uses tokens.

7 `/askai-plugins  Codex: $askai-plugins`

Then this. Finishes the one-time plugin setup and says when each tool is called.

8 `askai todo`

The few steps only you can do: sign-ins, restarts, MCP checks. Each clears itself once done.

PREFER A WINDOW?

`/askai-gui  Codex: $askai-gui`

Opens the Ask AI desktop app (same as askai desktop open). It runs the same commands as the terminal.

KEEPING IT CURRENT

`askai update`

Fetch the latest AskAI, install what is missing, refresh your projects. Then exit and reopen askai cli (or the Ask AI window).

Setup (installation & maintenance)

`askai install [--profile P] [--target T] [--retry] [--dry-run] [--yes] [options]`

Install and wire the token-saving setup for Claude Code, Codex, Antigravity and Cursor.

`askai update [--dry-run] [--check] [--agents] [install options]`

Update AskAI itself from GitHub and re-apply the recorded profile.

`askai tools update [--target T]`

Upgrade the tools AskAI installed and refresh its rule blocks.

`askai restore [stamp] [--dry-run] [--yes]`

List backup timestamps, or restore supported configuration files from one backup.

`askai uninstall [--only ID,ID] [--dry-run]`

Remove only what AskAI added: keys still holding AskAI's value, its marked blocks, its own files and registrations.

`askai profiles`

What each profile installs.

`askai suggest [dir]`

Recommend a profile from the files in a folder.

Health (diagnostics, audit & checks)

`askai check [dir] [--fix] [--json] [--env]`

Audit this machine and a repository against the token-saving guidelines.

`askai setup [dir] [--yes]`

Short check after install: which hosts are present, check counts, and whether the file validator passed.

`askai status [codex|antigravity|cursor|claude] [--host HOST] [--json] [--brief]`

Status in four environment columns, or one selected environment.

`askai why <finding-id>`

The message and fix for one finding from askai check.

`askai todo [dir] [--all] | askai todo done <id> | askai todo undo <id>`

Remaining setup and project-review steps: sign-ins, restarts, app settings, model IDs, one-time plugin steps, and repository facts that need confirmation. Checkable items clear themselves.

`askai test [--out FILE] [--json] [--real] [--notty] [--compare FILE]`

Run the safe commands one by one, print a short status, and write one capture file.

System (shell, CLI & environment)

`askai cli [--prepare] [--launch] [--review] [--path DIR] [--about TEXT]`

Prepare a project from the chat folder, then open an AskAI-only terminal. AI review is opt-in.

`askai desktop [open|install|remove|catalog|mode] [--project NAME|--repo PATH] [--dry-run]`

Open the Ask AI Windows/Linux desktop app for Markdown conversion and command output.

`askai shell init powershell|bash|zsh | install SHELL --path PROFILE | uninstall`

Enable terminal-scoped project selection in a shell.

`askai set project NAME | project --clear | default NAME | default --clear`

Select a project for this terminal or set a persistent fallback.

`askai statusline [--demo]`

Claude Code's status line command (reads the session JSON on stdin): model, context, cache; records snapshots for askai savings.

`askai version [--all] [--json]`

Print the AskAI version.

`askai help [category|command|all] | category NAME | command NAME`

List categories, show commands with one-line descriptions, or show detailed command help.

WHEN SOMETHING LOOKS WRONG

`askai install --retry`

A component failed or needs a new shell: fix the cause it names, then re-run. Finished components are skipped.

`exit, then askai cli  (GUI: close and reopen the window)`

After askai update the open shell still runs the old version.

`agent login  (in a terminal), then askai install --retry`

Cursor CLI not signed in: AskAI cannot check which models the account offers.

`askai project sync`

Agent files or tiers look old in a project.

`askai restore`

A settings file was changed wrongly: list backups and put one back.

AskAI while you work

[ ] optional < > required a | b pick one Full detail: askai help <command>

THE WORKING LOOP

1. `askai next`

At most 3 things to do now and 2 for later.

2. `askai go claude --tier build "task"`

Picks the model and effort once for the session. --tier lead for design, chore for cleanup. Codex, Cursor, agy work the same.

3. `askai prompt "rough ask"`

Turns a rough request into goal, files, done-when and a tier before you start.

4. `askai run -- <command>` | `askai errors`

Run a noisy command once, keep the log, read only the first errors.

5. `askai break` | `askai handoff` | `askai resume`

Before a break write the handoff; after one, continue or start fresh.

ARCHITECTURE DESIGN, ANALYSIS, SUPERVISION, REVIEW

`Claude Opus 5.5 (claude-opus-5-5), Extra High effort`

Ask for it explicitly, over Claude only, for bigger work or before a submission. No tier ever picks it automatically.

Work (active coding & session flow)

`askai next [dir]`

The top actions from askai check: at most 3 to do now and 2 for later.

`askai go <claude|codex|cursor|agy|task> [--tier lead|build|chore] ["task"] [--files a,b] [--done "..."] [--resume] [--dry-run]`

Start a session with the tier's model and effort fixed for the whole session, a structured first prompt, and a ledger entry.

`askai prompt "ask" [--tier T] [--kind bug|feature|design|risky|commit|firmware] [--files a,b] [--done "..."] [--mode blunt,brutal,assume,counter,contrast] [--copy] | --output-safe "cmd" | --resume`

Turn a rough or dictated ask into a structured prompt: goal, files, done-when, constraints, output limit, tier.

`askai run -- <command>`

Run a command, keep the full log in .ai-work/last.log, and print the exit code plus the last lines.

`askai errors [log]`

Print error lines from a log, with two lines of context, de-duplicated.

`askai diff [dir] [--review]`

git diff --stat, staged changes and the whitespace check, so you review a change before handing off; the agent gets only the files it needs.

`askai break [--summary "..."] [--next "..."] [--repo DIR] [--dry-run]`

Before a break: checklist, running agent CLIs, handoff reminder, a ledger entry and the break time.

`askai resume [--copy] [--repo DIR]`

Coming back: time away, continue-or-fresh advice from the cache lifetime, the handoff, git state, the resume prompt.

`askai handoff [dir] [--for claude|codex|cursor|agy] [--fill]`

Write .ai-work/HANDOFF.md from git facts. Judgment fields stay as TODO(you).

`askai clear [compact] [--tool claude|codex|cursor|agy] [--repo DIR]`

Gate before /clear or /compact: is the handoff fresh (under 30 minutes)? Prints the native command; AskAI cannot type into a running agent.

`askai snapshot [dir] [--include-untracked]`

Write a git diff patch and an untracked-file list under .ai-work/snapshots. Does not stash or commit.

`askai start --tool T --task "..." [--repo DIR]`

Start a task: ledger entry with tool, task, branch and last commit.

`askai stop [--yes]`

List running agent CLIs. --yes terminates them.

Project (repository, pack & architecture)

`askai project [dir] [--print|--remove] | list | show | rename OLD NEW | path NAME NEW_PATH | remove NAME | switch [NAME] | refresh [dir] | sync | hide-local [dir] [--personal|--shared|--undo] | build [select NAME] [--json] [--dry-run]`

Manage registered projects, or copy Cursor rules into a repository for teammates.

`askai init [dir] [--name NAME] [--path DIR] [--about "..."] [--type T] [--yes] [--refresh] [--offline] [--dry-run] [--build "cmd"] [--test "cmd"]`

Scan eligible first-party source files, consult detected frameworks' official docs, write a compact project knowledge pack and register its path.

`askai scaffold [dir] [--dry-run]`

Write the files every agent reads: AGENTS.md, CLAUDE.md, docs/ai/PROJECT_PROFILE.md, .cursorignore, .ai-work/. Never overwrites.

`askai review [status|done] [--project NAME] [--json] [--all]`

Show which project inputs changed since host AI review; record completion after review.

Project (repository, pack & architecture) · continued

`askai map [dir] [--dry-run] [--diff]`

Regenerate docs/ai/PROJECT_MAP.md from README folder descriptions and conventional names; preserve purposes you edited.

`askai graph [dir] | query "question" [--timeout 10] [--budget 600] | status [--json]`

Print the Mermaid architecture diagram from docs/ai/ARCHITECTURE.md and open it in the browser when the terminal is interactive.

`askai convert <file|url> [--out file.md] | askai convert scan [dir] [--yes] [--ignore-originals]`

Convert a PDF, Office file, web page or YouTube URL to Markdown with Microsoft MarkItDown, locally; never overwrites.

`askai context <percent> | --used N --window M`

What to do at this context level: continue, hand off, clear. 60% is a warning, not an order to compact.

`askai weigh <path> [--threshold N]`

Offline token estimate (chars/4), labeled estimate. Flags a file over the threshold.

`askai bootstrap [dir] [--profile P] [--repo]`

Show a personal devcontainer setup; --repo writes a post-create script into this project.

Cost & Levers (spend, tokens & levers)

`askai savings [days] [--cache] [--full] [--week] [--plugins] [--import-cursor FILE]`

Token savings reported by installed plugins, cache hits, and spend.

`askai session init|pause|status|finish|measure|report|quota [plan|report] [options]`

The per-repo ledger in .ai-work/: entries, handoff, measurements, report. askai start, askai break and askai resume are the daily names for those three actions.

`askai audit [dir] [--tool claude|codex|cursor|agy] [--project name|dir] [--json]`

The seven-point token audit: memory files, tools and proxies, model and effort, hooks, subagents, scheduled work, cache reuse.

`askai models [set <tool>.<tier> <model>[:<effort>] | verify [tool]]`

Model and effort per task tier (lead, build, chore) for each tool; used by askai go and the agent files.

`askai route "task"`

Pick a tier from the task words and print the cheaper-first escalation rule. Does not launch an agent.

`askai mcp [list | verify [NAME] | on NAME | off NAME] [--tool claude|codex|cursor|agy] [--json] | telemetry [--json] | import FILE --tool T [--dry-run] | connections [--tool T] [--json] | confirm NAME --tool T --success 1|0 --notes TEXT [--test-tool NAME] [--dry-run]`

Every MCP server in the four tools, and a switch: Antigravity's disabled flag, Codex's enabled key, parking for Claude Code and Cursor.

`askai plugins [list | ready [dir] | info <id> | install <id> | decisions]`

Every token tool researched: evidence, what runs on its own versus by command, installed or not. ready says which connected tools wait for a matching task, and the one-time steps still left.

`askai infra [dir] [--json]`

Tools and repository files.

Learn (guides, habits & etiquette)

`askai ask <words>`

Offline answers on etiquette and the research: the rule, why, the command in each tool, and what AskAI automates.

`askai guide [install|start|work|break|resume|clear|compact|cache|models|subagents|mcp|output|prompts|docs|plugins|peak|all]`

The etiquette for each moment of work, offline.

`askai tips [claude|codex|agy|cursor|session|habits|peak]`

The cheat sheet, offline, per tool. peak says whether Claude is in peak hours now.

`askai direction`

Print the one-screen working loop and the most useful command choices.

`askai docs [install|architecture|projects|guide|cheatsheet|changelog|preview|container|support|check] [--print]`

Find AskAI documents or check generated command documentation for drift.

`askai chat [claude|chatgpt|gemini|code] [--copy]`

Where to paste a short standing instruction in Claude chat, ChatGPT, and Gemini, and how the four coding apps are set up instead.

Reference notes

askai savings reads Claude Code and Codex only. Cursor, Claude chat and ChatGPT show usage in their own settings.
AskAI's own folder is ~/.askai on a fresh install (older installs keep ~/.claude/askai). askai models shows the tiers per tool.
Generated from lib/help.js (askai 1.3.0). Regenerate: python scripts/build-cheatsheets.py